

Week 12: Video Transcript

Hello everyone and welcome to our final class together. Today we are centering celebration and appreciation for how you have grown as a person throughout this process, how you have grown in your skillset as a parent, your awareness of yourself as a parent, as a person, and checking in on how you have met your intention. You started our program by setting your intention as an empowered parent. You were invited to dig into your strengths that you have as a parent and move into this process from a strength-centered perspective. And we are now centering the shifts that you have made in this program and we are uncentering all of the places that you wish you were further along in, or that you had excelled more in, or that isn't quite up to where you thought that you would be.

We are living in a universal culture of instant gratification and wanting what we want when we want it, and not settling for anything less. Which is so ironic because for generations, we've been told to not raise our children and spoil them, and so we've withheld emotional intimacy. We've withheld giving them what they need versus what they want, and that's actually created a population of people who really struggle with patience and really struggle with a perspective and a permission to focus on what's going well. We're really stuck in that negative loop brain. We focus on what's not going well, what's not going right, and what's not good enough. We see our progress through the lens of "not quite there". And that's not very fun, that's not very celebratory. So we're just wanting to name that. Just let that be so you have awareness of when you dismiss or invalidate your progress, or when you numb down or fluff off the work that you have done in the ways that you really have grown and evolved as a person, in your relationship with your child, and the dynamics that you were struggling with before you entered this program. And I'll give you a little secret. I'm the director of education at the Jai Institute for Parenting. I've heralded hundreds and hundreds and hundreds of people through this process. I know this work inside out, I've gone through this program fifty times or more, and I still struggle as a parent.

The intention is for you to not have zero struggle in your life and for your relationship with your child to be seamless and effortless, and you never ever get angry, and you never ever enter fight or flight and aren't able to regulate yourself. I want us to center instead, tiny victories that you've experienced along the way. It is building blocks of tiny victories that propel us toward our vision of what is possible. This is so much bigger than you.



This is so much bigger than you, your child, and your family. This is the future of humanity, which sounds really intense. And it's also very humbling to understand that the work that you're doing here in this program into your life, this isn't the last time you're going to dig into self-awareness, self-growth, and transformation. I'm hoping that this is one drop in your bucket, and I hope you never stop learning and growing. And we need to pair that with our permission to rest, and permission to be as we're in that process of continual evolution, growth, becoming, transformation, shedding skin, and growing fuller and bigger. We're also going to contract, we're going to pause, we're going to go deep within, and we're going to allow ourselves deep healing rest after a big state of expansion.

You've been invited into twelve weeks of non stop movement. It is tough. You ran a marathon. These tiny victories are building the blocks of perseverance that you need to live a life of contraction and expansion. Allow yourself to contract here, allow yourself to look within and name the tiny victories that you have experienced along the way. We have a workbook for you this week, and it's checking in on your original intention and intentions. And then we go step by step through every segment that you've learned here in this work and how it has changed you, how you have grown, shifted, and shed. What is different about you as you're leaving this program than when you entered it? And if "all" you were leaving this program with is more awareness of when you interrupt your child or how much studying you need to do to expand your feelings vocabulary, I find that as a victory. So I don't want us to have the barometer of measuring your "success" in this program as, are you the ideal vision of yourself? That lives on an eternal horizon. I'm not sure when we're going to get there, but let me know if you do. Sense of humor, lightheartedness, it's just going to keep going.

So we're going to look in the workbook, go step by step through how you've changed, and your coach will help you to self appreciate. Authentic appreciation is a beautiful practice, and it is rooted in self empathy, unconditional love, and acceptance. And it is a three-step process that's based in nonviolent communication. It's making a neutral observation of what you're appreciative of, to naming a feeling that's connected and it's maybe a need that it met. So let's say that I am making a neutral observation where I just completed this 12 week process. I felt really nervous to begin it because I didn't know what to expect and now that I'm done, I feel so uplifted. I feel so joyous. I feel so grateful and proud of myself because my need for self-respect has been met for growth, celebration, authenticity, and belonging have been met. And it's a really beautiful practice to center. You don't have to sensationalize, "I am amazing, and I did this amazing work and I'm incredible. I'm the most brave thing that's ever lived on the planet".



Just like with our children, that kind of overwhelming praise can be hard to digest and really feel in our cells, our heart, and our brain. We're wanting something that can settle and soothe the system, and will give us the energy we need to call on when we're running low on steam. We are also looking at your willingness to allow yourself to rest and not do any self-development work. Just chill out a little bit. That's probably the hardest part of the journey for many people. Is this "I gotta keep going. I gotta keep getting better. I can't stop". It's fear-driven, it's shame driven, and we're wanting to take the urgency out of this practice and enter any future developmental work that you engage in as a parent, a person, a lover, a loved one, a partner, a daughter, a sister, a son, an uncle, you get what I'm saying. If I have a place of safety and a belief that how I am right now is enough, and how exciting is it that I could get even bigger? I could become even more me. I could become even more courageous, more beautiful, more playful, more lighthearted, more connected, more present, more intimate, and more creative. It's limitless. We're wanting to create our future from that space. And I want to commend you all for this work, because I know how old, deep, and thick all of this is. All of these histories that we've been carrying in our body, in our waters, and our brain.

And I know how revealing and upheaving this process is, and I appreciate your presence to show up imperfectly and your willingness to word and confront yourselves, confront your thoughts, confront what you believed was true. Maybe some of you entered this program very separated from what we teach here and this was a huge learning curve for you. Where some of you were already in the thick of conscious, empowered parenting, and this has taken you to a whole other layer of what is possible in your relationship with your child. Wherever it is that you sit on the continuum, there's no right or wrong place. I appreciate you being here and I trust in you so much. I trust that what has happened within you throughout this process may defy words, may defy explanation, and maybe happening more deeply than you can really understand and conceptualize. So even if you're leaving here with a longing of, "I still really want to try to understand boundaries better, or I really still struggle with self-regulation, or I just can't play". You don't have to end, you can continue working on these specific areas with your coach.

We've given you a twelve week map. You could spend a year in every week. You could spend a month in every week and stretch this out for a year long program. So you get to create what you want with your coach. You're the artist of your life and your coach is the artist of their life. And two artists in a room is the best thing ever. I'm so excited for you. I love you, I love your children, and I am so honored to have been your teacher and facilitator through this process here in your workbooks. If you're working and coming to a conclusion with your coach, please have a beautiful celebration.



If anyone here feels inspired to learn more about this work, please visit us at the Jai Institute for Parenting. We teach mamas, papas, grandpas, grandparents, teachers, therapists, social workers, all kinds of folks all over the planet to become parenting coaches. We have so many coaches now who were once clients in this program, and it's a beautiful cycle of connectivity and passing the torch to as many people that could possibly receive the gift of illumination. I thank you, enjoy your workbook.

Be gracious with yourself, grant yourself permission to center celebration, pride, and appreciation. I will see you somewhere out there in the universe. Goodbye everyone, take care and lots of love from the Jai Institute, from your coach, and from empowered parents everywhere.

Thank you.

